ANKUR SHEEL

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SUMMARY

I am a software developer who strives to help people become more efficient and productive. My background is a mix of fast-paced startup environments and the structured complexity of large-scale enterprises. In a previous life, I have worked as a game developer. I enjoy building tools which help reduce the time taken by my team members to complete tasks as well as making code maintainable by using refactoring techniques and adding test coverage. I take an active interest in improving processes to benefit my team members. I'm usually building my own side projects and blogging about whatever new tech I've picked up.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer – Woolworths (NZ)

Auckland, New Zealand | May 2026 - Present
Technology: C#, TypeScript, React

Worked in the Loyalty and Subscription Team

- Implemented features for the website to enhance user engagement and experience.

Software Engineer - Atlassian

Remote (Auckland) | Nov 2022 - Mar 2026
Technology: Java, TypeScript, React

Worked in the Jira Issue Backend Platform team (~30 engineers).

- Feature Led initiatives to improve core platform performance.
- Reduced Jira attachment load latency by 90ms at P90.
- Increased Issue Create API reliability by implementing idempotent retries. The underlying infrastructure was later used to make other REST APIs idempotent.
- Implemented support for renaming Jira projects containing large numbers of issues, removing a long-standing operational limitation.
- Built an IntelliJ plugin to simplify feature flag cleanup.
- Built a Forge app reducing feature-flag rollout preparation from 20 minutes to 5 minutes.
- Mentored junior engineers.

Senior Software Engineer - First AML
Auckland, New Zealand | Nov 2019 - Oct 2022
Technology: C#, GraphQL

Joined as the second backend engineer and the 12th employee. Helped grow Product & Engineering team to 20+ members.

- Automated identity verification workflow, cutting analyst time from 5+ minutes to <1 minute per verification.
- Designed and developed entity-copy functionality, reducing task time from 20+ minutes to seconds.
- Built email integrations to power the forms sent to end users. I also created a Slack integration to notify analysts if an email could not be sent due to bounce or complaint errors.
- Built backend feature flag system enabling safer releases and smaller PRs, plus open-source CLI for flag management.
- Migrated backend GraphQL implementation from GraphQL.NET to HotChocolate and established API conventions.
- Ran introductory sessions for Insomnia and feature flags for engineers new to the tooling.
- Introduced developer productivity initiatives: No-Meeting Thursdays, retrospectives, lunch-and-learns.

Earlier Career (2005–2019)
Technology: C#, GraphQL, VisualBasic, C++, COBOL

Pushpay, Vista Entertainment Solutions, Gameloft (New Zealand), Knowledge Adventure India Private Ltd, BlueGiant Interactive Private Ltd, Trine Game Studios, Dhruva Interactive, Perot Systems (India)

SELECTED PERSONAL PROJECTS

- Wordxplorer: Wordle-style educational game for children built with Unity and C#, published on the App Store and Google Play.
- xUnitHelpers: helper library that simplifies writing tests with xUnit.
- FeatureFlagHelper: CLI tool for modifying feature flag JSON files across multiple environments.
- StatiqHelpers: wrapper around Statiq.Web to build my static websites.

You can find more projects at ***https://www.ankursheel.com/cv***

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Science - University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science and Engineering - Manipal Institute of Technology, Manipal, India